

Rebirth - Axiom Built Into Buddha's Worldview

Axiom = Cornerstone of a theory;
cannot be removed/altered.

A theory is valued on its merits.

Does the theory have: (i) **Explanatory power**, (ii) **Predictive power**?

One can accept or reject the theory, **but not alter it**.

Many **wrong views** exist about rebirth

Buddha described 62 wrong views (Ref.1), belonging to **two categories**:

Many believe they will be merged with the Creator (or born in Hell) at death to live forever (**Sassata diṭṭhi**)

Some others believe life does not continue after death (**Uccheda diṭṭhi**)

Buddha's worldview has rebirth among 31 realms as a cornerstone. Instead of **accepting/rejecting rebirth blindly**, examine that **worldview** carefully

Predictive power
(recorded in the *Tiṭṭaka*:

Existence of uncountable number of stars in universe (modern science was unaware until 200 years ago)

Uncountable number of planetary systems (modern science was unaware until 50 years ago)

Most planetary systems have life (modern science has not confirmed yet)

Explanatory power with empirical evidence:

Rebirth accounts by children over the world

Near-Death-Experience (NDE) accounts from physicians

Why some are born rich/poor, healthy/unhealthy, etc.

Some people ask for proof of rebirth

Just like the existence of a Creator cannot be proven or disproven, rebirth cannot be "proven or disproven"

Instead ask **"Are there any inconsistencies within Buddha's worldview?"**

A proper examination must include *Sutta*, *Vinaya*, and *Abhidhamma Piṭaka*

Rebirth in Buddha Dhamma is **not up for debate**. One can either accept or reject it (Ref. 2).